



Nonna Mei

Mumbai-based chef Niyati Rao's Nonna Mei is an exciting new addition to Shillong's food map. As the name suggests—Nonna is Italian for grandmother and Mei is the Khasi word for mother—the restaurant blends local flavours into classic Italian dishes. The menu is short and deeply considered, but expect a hold-onto-your-hat culinary adventure. Think bruschetta topped with jyllang (garlic chives) and Spaghetti Aglio e Olio with shrimp marinated in bitchi (Garo fermented rice wine). This fusion also extends to their beverages list that features smoked pork and the Lakadong

Trattoria

Shillong is dotted with Ja-sha (rice and tea) shops or Jadoh stalls where food is slow-cooked and there is no menu. Typically, you'd have a few pork, chicken and fish dishes, seasonal vegetables, rice, dal, chutneys and salad. At the counter, you pick what you want and it's all served on a plate. For almost 50 years, Trattoria in the heart of Shillong has been a favourite among locals. "It's the closest to home food you can eat outside," is how entrepreneur and hotelier Larsing Ming Sawyan explains Trattoria's enduring popularity. His typical lunch order includes Jadoh (rice cooked with pork fat and blood), doh nei ïong







Hotelier Larsing Ming Sawyan; inset, pork curry and a typical meal at Trattoria

(pork in black sesame gravy), doh shain (minced pork or beef meatballs). Apart from seasonal vegetables, this would also include sides like doh khlieh (pig's head salad) and tungtap (fermented fish chutney). "It's no-fuss, soul-satisfying food," adds Sawyan.

Address: MUDA, Police Bazaar